

We'll shortly consider some ways of responding to Edwards' argument. But first let's think about how Edwards' argument might be related to an argument for fatalism.

Suppose that someone did not believe in God — and hence rejected premise (2) of Edwards' argument — but did believe that there were truths about all of our future actions. Could they give an argument similar to Edwards' argument?

There are truths
about our future
actions.

We have no
choice about the
past.

If we have no choice
about A, and no
choice about the
connection between
A and B, then we
have no choice about
B.

In the past, God
had
foreknowledge of
our future
actions.

To get a grip on this, imagine that one learned of another universe, which had its own system of time and space. And suppose one was given all of the information about everything that ever happens in that universe, and the time at which it happens. So, in particular, you know everything about every free action in that universe. But it's not like you knew of every action **before** that action occurred — you don't exist in the time of that universe.

Does the claim that God exists outside of time give us
reason to reject premise (2) of the foreknowledge
argument?

Let's look again at the premises which make
reference to time.

Does the claim that God exists outside of time give us
reason to reject premise (2) of the Foreknowledge
Argument?

1. We have no choice about what God knows in the past.
2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)

It does look like, if Aquinas' view is right, (2) is false.

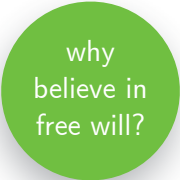
That is good for the defender of free will.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

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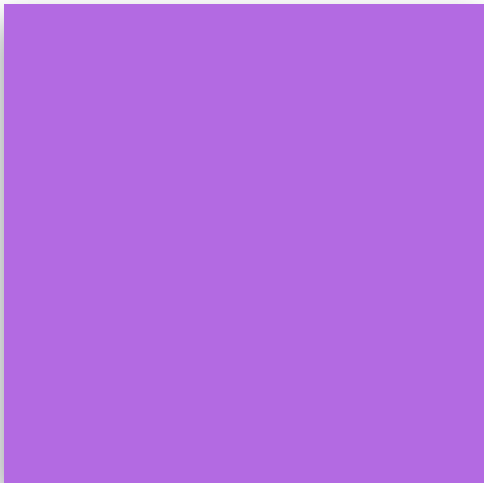
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Argument?

reason to reject premise (2) of the Forkwledge

Does the claim that God exists outside of time give us



in the past.

or if it is not in its:

3. We have not checked that

God knows that in the future I will

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of

performancetainaction.(1,2)

1. We have not heard what God knows

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with reference to the being of truth about

God only shows up in premises (2) and

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

our future actions.



all of our activities.

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

that if it is true that I will perform

then we have the choice about q.

acaioid.

2* In the past, there were truths about



perform a certain action (1,2)

(3, 4, 5)

3 We have not the fact that

5* We have not noticed the fact

God knows that in the future I will

1. We have no direct facts.

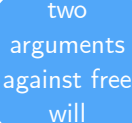
some action, then I will prefer that

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

0 We have achieved what we

will perform various actions.

The fatalist argument



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
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why
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three
ways out

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predict.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.

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God knows that in the future I will

3. We have not checked that

1. We have no choice about past facts.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of

overtaking:

performancetrain.action.(1,2)

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